

CELERIAC *Apium graveolens* var. *rapaceum*

Celeriac is, botanically speaking, very similar to celery but with a swollen lower stem that can be eaten cooked, or grated and eaten raw. The texture of celeriac is similar to that of turnips and its flavor is mild and celerylike. Unlike celery, however, it is lifted in late fall and will store well in frost-free sheds and cellars. It is popular in cooler regions, where celery is easily damaged.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Celeriac is tolerant of most locations and should be treated in the same way as celery: enrich the soil with plenty of compost or organic matter, adding general fertilizer shortly before planting. Add lime, too, if the soil is acidic.

Sow seed thinly in shallow pots and barely cover with a layer of soil. Move seedlings into small, individual pots when they have developed three leaves, and place them in moderate warmth in a bright greenhouse or similar environment until the roots have grown to fill the pot. Plants will usually benefit from supplementary fertilizer.

Like celery, celeriac bolts if planted out too early, reducing the crop. To avoid this, plant out



Allow seedlings plenty of space to grow.

greenhouse-grown, mid-spring sowings in early summer.

CROP CARE

Water plants frequently, especially in dry periods, since they must not be allowed to dry out; celeriac is a little more tolerant of dry soil than celery. Apply additional general fertilizer if growth is slow. Any side-shoots or fallen foliage